economic crisis of the 1990s meant that Cuban filmmakers had to turn abroad for funding, which brought both new challenges and new opportunities.

Music

Cuba's musical heritage is vast, as are its contributions to world music. In the United States, Cuban music probably had its largest impact through its influence on the development of the genres of jazz in the first half of the twentieth century, and salsa in the second.

Some aspects of Cuban music were affected or transformed by the Revolution, while in others, the island's musical traditions simply continued their own trajectories. Singer-songwriters like Carlos Puebla, Silvio Rodríguez and Pablo Milanés became the musical face of the Cuban Revolution in much of the Spanish-speaking world during the 1970s and 80s and beyond. Traditional Cuban *son* music underwent an international revival in the 1990s with the release of "The Buena Vista Social Club" CD in 1997, and the film in 1999. Newer variations on the traditional forms, ranging from rap to reggaeton, also flourished in the 1990s and into the new century.

Puebla is best known for his topical songs, commenting on the political and social realities especially during the early years of the Revolution. His best-known song is probably "Hasta Siempre, Comandante," written in 1965 when Che left Cuba to spread the Revolution elsewhere in Africa and Latin America. "Your revolutionary love is taking you to new places, where they await the strength of your arms in liberation," he sang. "Here we are left with the clear, intimate transparence of your beloved presence."

The "New Song" movement in Latin America, and its Cuban version, the "Nueva Trova," aimed to challenge the commercial and foreign domination of the airwaves with authentically local and meaningful music. From Chile to Mexico, musicians turned to indigenous and local musical roots and developed a music that engaged with, rather than served to escape from, Latin American realities. The protest music movement in the United States in the 1960s and 70s, with artists like